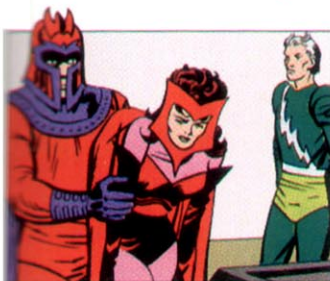


SCARLET WITCH

Magical mistress of "Hex Power"



After Magneto rescued the Scarlet Witch from certain death, she and her brother Quicksilver became members of his Brotherhood of Evil Mutants. They didn't learn that Magneto was actually their father until many years later.

Studying witchcraft has helped the Scarlet Witch hone her control over her mutant abilities.

Wanda Maximoff is the daughter of Erik Magnus Lehnsherr also known as the mutant criminal MAGNETO and the twin sister of Pietro Maximoff, the former Avenger QUICKSILVER. Wanda's mother ran away from Magneto while she was pregnant and, fearing her husband would exploit her unborn children, gave her twins up for adoption.

SOCIAL OUTCAST

The twins were raised in the eastern European country of Transia by a gypsy couple and Wanda soon learned that she could cause strange things to happen. After accidentally making a house to burst into flame, she was about to be stoned as a witch when Magneto arrived and saved her. Not realizing that he was their real father, Wanda and Pietro took on costumed identities and joined his war against humanity. After many battles with the X-MEN, the twins abandoned Magneto and later joined the AVENGERS in return for full pardons for their past crimes. Over her brother's objections, Wanda became attracted to the synthozoid called the Vision and began a long romance with him. They were eventually married and set up house in New Jersey.

TROUBLED SOUL

Wanda also began to study real magic, combining it with her natural mutant abilities. She eventually grew powerful enough to defeat the dreaded DORMAMMU. However, her increased power came at a terrible cost and she began to lose her grip on reality. She conjured up imaginary children and repeatedly experienced temporary bouts of insanity.

The Vision was disassembled by the US government after trying to bring a new golden age to humanity by seizing mental control of every computer on Earth. Hank Pym and the BLACK PANTHER later rebuilt him, but he no longer possessed emotions, including the ability to love. His relationship with Wanda disintegrated and rapidly ended in divorce. The Scarlet Witch later suffered another mental breakdown and launched an attack on her fellow Avengers that resulted in the destruction of the Avengers Mansion and a number of tragic deaths. She later used her powers to warp reality and permanently remove the mutant gene and powers from most of the mutants, including herself. Since M-Day, Wanda has been seen living a normal life with no memory of being the Scarlet Witch. Recently, Scarlet Witch returned to help Hank Pym assemble a new team of Avengers, but turned out to be LOKI in disguise. **TD, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers: The Yesterday Quest (tpb)**

The Scarlet Witch learns her true origins.

- **The Vision and Scarlet Witch #1-12**

The Vision and Scarlet Witch leave the Avengers and move to the suburbs.

- **Avengers: Avengers Disassembled (tpb)**

The Scarlet Witch goes mad and attacks the Avengers, killing many of her former comrades.

- **House Of M (tpb)**

The Scarlet Witch restructures reality and eliminates most of the mutants on Earth.



The Scarlet Witch and the Vision were married in the same ceremony that united Mantis and the Cotati.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Wanda Maximoff, aka Wanda Frank, Wanda Magnus

OCCUPATION

Advertiser

BASE

Europe

HEIGHT 5 ft 7 in

WEIGHT 130 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Auburn

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men #4
(March 1964)

Possessed ability to affect probability fields to cause unlikely events to occur. Could make objects spontaneously burst into flame, rust or decay. Her "hex bolts" could also deflect flying objects and disrupt energy transmissions or fields. However, recent evidence seems to indicate that the Scarlet Witch has lost her mutant powers.



Through gestures and mental concentration, the Scarlet Witch creates finite pockets of force that can disrupt reality. She can hurl these "hex-spheres" at her intended targets.

Suffering from a breakdown, the Scarlet Witch altered reality enough to disassemble the Avengers and eliminate most of Earth's mutants.



SCARLET WITCH

POWERS